



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Greenwich Classical Academy  
School Website: <http://greenwichacademy.org>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**SCL MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Greenwich Academy (ZIP 06830) publicly emphasizes character formation, leadership development, and a robust, interdisciplinary private-school program with strong language study (including Latin) and extensive co-curricular offerings. While Latin and some cross-disciplinary practices appear, the materials do not consistently reveal the core Great Books/Trivium-based curriculum, explicit Socratic pedagogy, or scholé (restful) teaching as foundational methods. Based on the presence/absence of the Six Essential Elements indicators and the school's publicly stated priorities, this evaluation classifies Greenwich Academy as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall. The school shows several classical-leaning signals (notably Latin and leadership-focused formation, some integration of curricula and public-purpose activities), but it lacks pervasive evidence of a fully classical liturgical-theological base, deep Great Books engagement, and sustained Socratic/seminar pedagogy across grades.

Key drivers for the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating: - Positive classical indicators present: Latin study, some cross-disciplinary programs, emphasis on virtue/character through leadership-oriented initiatives, public purpose, and a living-faculty/mentor-type ethos in advisory structures. Evidence includes explicit Latin coursework in the language program and a characterization of character and leadership as central to GA's mission and programs. - Gaps relative to a full classical model: Limited explicit references to Great Books, a traditional Trivium/Quadrivium framework, or sustained Socratic pedagogy; scarcity of liturgical/theological foundations in public materials; pedagogy evidence is more contemporary and leadership- and wellness-oriented than strictly scholé or Socratic. These gaps anchor the assessment away from CLASSICAL and toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The publicly available GA materials show no explicit theology, liturgy, or liturgical communal practices. The site emphasizes character, community, and leadership rather than a transcendent metaphysical framework. Notable elements include governance by "Center for Public Purpose" and leadership themes rather than a liturgical or sacramental program.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators from the classical lexicon would include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder. Present GA content does not clearly foreground these terms as foundational axioms; it emphasizes character and leadership rather than transcendentals. Positive keywords present: 0–1 (character/virtue-related ideas are present in leadership language but do not map cleanly to the lexicon's religious/metaphysical terms). Negative keywords present: 0.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive 0–1 vs Negative 0 (~0–16% of target positive signals)

- Why this rating
- Without explicit theological grounding, liturgical life, or transcendental metaphysical framing in public materials, the school does not meet the Core Rel/Metaphysical expectations of a classical school. The presence of character/virtue language is a helpful sign but not a replacement for theology-liturgical foundations in this rubric.

### **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school foregrounds character, leadership, and public purpose as central aims, indicating formation of virtue and humane excellence rather than mere information transfer. Centered concepts include “Character and leadership are the twin poles setting GA’s axis” and programs designed to cultivate social-emotional and leadership capacities (e.g., Career Resource Center, Center for Public Purpose).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: character, virtue (mapped through the virtue/formation lens), leadership, public purpose. Negative keywords: none clearly present in the GA materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive ~3–4, Negative 0; Positive ~75–100% of the relevant signals for this category.
- Why this rating
- The emphasis on virtue-oriented formation and leadership aligns with classical aims of human flourishing and telos, though the framing stops short of a fully classical telos grounded in the true/good/beautiful trinity, Great Books, or scholé pedagogy. Given the strong formation orientation, this category warrants SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

### **Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Latin is explicitly part of the language program (“a required Latin course”). This is a clear classical-language signal. The materials also show a broad liberal-arts style in language instruction and cross-disciplinary offerings (e.g., current events, writing/public speaking). However, there is limited explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, or a formal Trivium/Quadrivium structure in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Latin, language study, writing, public speaking (signals related to classical grammar/eloquence and rhetoric). Great Books/Great Conversation is not explicitly present in the accessible public materials. Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive 1–2; Negative 0–1 (net tilt toward positive due to Latin). Overall: ~50–70% positive relative to the classical-curriculum indicators.
- Why this rating
- Latin presence is a meaningful classical cue, but the absence of explicit Great Books engagement and the lack of a clearly articulated Trivium/Quadrivium framework in public materials temper the curriculum rating. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public GA materials emphasize leadership, advisory models, and wellness, with limited explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, Scholé (restful learning), or classic memory/recitation pedagogy in daily practice. The strong emphasis on contemporary programs (e.g., advisory, career centers, public-sphere leadership) suggests a broad, modern pedagogy rather than a strictly classical approach.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive classical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work, recitation, etc.) are not clearly present in GA’s public content. Negative indicators (absence of these signals) are present,

while some leadership/communication programs are not part of the classical pedagogy lexicon.

- Quantitative estimate: Positive 0; Negative 1–2 (absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals is a negative in this rubric's terms)
- Why this rating
- Without explicit, codified classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé, rhetoric training tied to classical practice) in the public materials, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL. The presence of some modern pedagogical modes does not compensate for the lack of classical pedagogy signals.

#### **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public materials describe advisory models, mentors, and a culture in which teachers act as guides and coaches (e.g., Center for Public Purpose; leadership emphasis; advisory relationships). This aligns with a “living curriculum” and mentor-like faculty in classical sense, albeit not explicitly as a formal “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” description.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor/guide, living curriculum potential, collegial culture (as implied by advisory structures). Negative keywords: none clearly indicated.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive 2–3; Negative 0; Positive ~60–100% relative signals in this area.
- Why this rating
- The faculty appears to function in mentor/advocate roles and to support formation, which maps to some classical expectations about the teacher-student relationship and “living curriculum.” The lack of explicit classical-faculty descriptors reduces this to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

#### **Element 6: Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The GA site includes “Our Community” and “Diversity & Inclusion,” with emphasis on partnerships and family involvement, plus signals of accessible engagement through admissions processes and community programs. This points to a community orientation with parental involvement as part of the ecosystem (though the public materials do not clearly delineate “parents as co-teachers” in the classical sense).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents (implied by “Our Community,” family engagement signals, and admissions processes); parent education pieces are not as explicit in the accessible material, but the community orientation is clear. Negative keywords: none clearly stated in public materials.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive 1–2; Negative 0; Positive ~50–100% relative to signals.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates a community-centric approach and engagement with families, which aligns with classical education’s emphasis on parents as co-educators in a broader sense, though the materials do not explicitly spell out “parents as co-teachers.” This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Overall aggregate ranking - Based on category-by-category signals (1: NOT CLASSICAL, 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 4: NOT CLASSICAL, 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), the school lands in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL quadrant overall. The mix of Latin language emphasis and leadership/formation programs contribute to its partial classical identity, but the lack of explicit Great Books engagement, scholé pedagogy, and a fully articulated Trivium/Quadrivium framework prevents a full CLASSICAL rating. Evidence drawn from the GA public materials and the classical-education rubric supports this conclusion.

What would move the needle

- Explicit Great Books / Great Conversation integration: Publicly enumerate a Great Books program and cross-disciplinary Great Conversation elements (e.g., assign canonical texts and structured dis-

cussions across divisions).

- Codify and publish a Scholé-based pedagogy: Include restful learning cycles, memorization/recitation as appropriate, and a commitment to slower, contemplative pedagogy across key grades.
- Strengthen Socratic / seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades: Introduce regular Socratic seminars (Harkness-style discussions) for core humanities and integrate rhetoric training to culminate in meaningful student orations and public speaking.
- Expand and publicly articulate the Trivium/Quadrivium framework: Anchor the curriculum in grammar, logic, rhetoric as a scaffold with math/science/arts aligned to a Quadrivium progression, making the classical structure explicit on the website.
- Deepen liturgical/theological grounding (where appropriate for the school's mission): If the school intends to maintain a classical, transcendent framework, consider a defined religious/metaphysical strand or clearly explained compatible rituals, rituals of learning, or communal practices that align with the classical tradition.
- Elevate the "faculty living curriculum" language: Publish a formal portrait of a teacher and explicit statements about faculty-as-living-curriculum, mentorship roles, and teacher formation in classical pedagogy.
- Strengthen parent formation and co-teaching language: Provide more explicit opportunities for parental formation (book studies, classical education seminars) and confirm an open-campus approach with defined co-teaching expectations.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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